MONK'S DREAM JAZZ BAR DIGITAL OPERATIONS PLATFORM

Full Plan & User Stories — POS, Inventory, Attendance, Team Chat

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1. Executive Summary

This proposal outlines a single, integrated local (on-premise, LAN-based) platform for the jazz bar covering POS, Inventory, Staff Attendance, and internal Team Chat. Orders are automatically routed to the correct station (Cafe, Bar, or Food) based on item, with live status tracking, while billing is handled through a flexible tab system that supports groups splitting their bill at any point — not just at the start.

The system is designed to be simple enough for a new, untrained waiter to use safely: guided steps, confirmations before irreversible actions, and sensible defaults, so mistakes are hard to make and easy to undo.

2. User Roles & Permissions

Role	Scope	Can do
Admin	Full system	CRUD menu items, manage users, view all stations live, full inventory, approve voids (personal code), run/export all reports, manage schedules, oversee Team Chat
Waiter/Cashier (merged)	Front-of-house	Open tables, take orders, split/merge tabs, send to stations, process payment, clock in/out, request voids, use Team Chat
Cafe (Staff & Station)	Cafe station only	View cafe-tagged tickets, update status, adjust cafe stock, clock in/out, Team Chat
Bar (Staff & Station)	Bar station only	View bar-tagged tickets, update status, adjust bar stock, clock in/out, Team Chat
Food (Staff & Station)	Food station only	View food-tagged tickets, update status, adjust food stock, clock in/out, Team Chat

Waiter and Cashier are merged into one role since the same person takes the order and handles payment — no separate cashier login is needed.

3. Taking Orders — 2D Visual Table Layout

- Single floor — one fixed 2D layout matching the bar's real table arrangement; no floor switching needed.
- Tap a table to open it; every table starts as one tab by default — no upfront decision about splitting is required.
- Guided order flow: category tabs, large buttons, minimal typing, and a confirmation step (“Send to Bar & Food?”) before an order reaches a station.
- Short undo window after sending, to catch honest mis-taps before a station starts prepping.
- Status shown as color + icon + label together (not color alone, for accessibility):
  - Gray / outline = empty Blue / person = occupied, no order yet
  - Yellow / clock = preparing Green / check = ready to serve

    - Orange / plate = served, bill not requested Red / receipt = bill requested
- Badge = multiple split tabs open on that table
- System auto-prompts “Split this bill?” when an order sits open a while or grows large, instead of relying on staff memory.

4. Order Routing to Stations

- Orders route only to their specific station (Cafe / Bar / Food) — clean, uncluttered queues per station.
- Multi-station items (e.g. an Irish coffee) appear on every relevant station screen.
- Ticket status: New → Preparing → Ready, with a dedicated “Ready” button that instantly updates the waiter's view and the table's floor-plan status.
- Routing is based on menu-item tagging (set by Admin) and is completely independent of how the table eventually splits its bill.

5. Split Payments & Multiple Groups at One Table

Groups often don't decide to split the bill until the very end. The system is built around that reality rather than assuming a split decision upfront.

- Every table starts as one single tab; orders go in normally with no upfront split decision.
- “Split Tab” is available at any time — mid-order or right before payment.
- Split Evenly (default, one-tap) or Split by Item (assign already-ordered items to Tab A/B/etc. via tap/drag).
- Because station routing already happened independently of billing, splitting after items are sent causes zero disruption to the kitchen or bar.
- Tabs can be merged back together if the group changes its mind again.
- Supports custom-amount splits and mixed tender (e.g. one person cash, another card).
- Each tab closes and receipts independently; receipt history links split tabs back to their parent table.

6. Team Chats

A built-in messaging layer so staff aren't relying on shouting across a noisy jazz bar or personal phones during service.

- Role/station-based channels: Bar, Kitchen, Cafe, All-Staff, and an Admin/Manager channel.
- Direct messages between individual staff members (e.g. Waiter ↔ Bar).
- Common uses: ‘86 the salmon,” “table 6 needs a manager,” break coverage requests, shift handoff notes.
- Pinned/urgent message option so critical alerts don't get buried in normal chatter.
- Quick-tag shortcuts tied to context — e.g. tapping “Need Manager” on a table auto-sends a pre-filled message with the table number attached.

- Full chat history retained and viewable by Admin, same accountability standard as other modules.
- Runs on the same local network/server as the rest of the system — no external app or internet dependency.
- Non-intrusive but noticeable notifications, so chat doesn't compete with louder order-ready alerts.

7. POS Module

7.1 Corkage Fee — Flat 20%

Corkage is a flat 20% fee, applied automatically whenever a “bring your own bottle” item is selected — no manual entry or staff judgment call required, removing the chance it gets forgotten.

7.2 Corkage & Revenue Reporting — Option C (Adopted)

Corkage is tracked as its own category, separate from menu-item sales, but viewable together when needed:

- Total Sales of the Day (default view) reflects food & drink sales only — an accurate picture of actual menu performance.
- Corkage Fees Collected is shown as its own distinct total, always visible, never hidden.
- A “Total incl. Corkage” toggle/figure is available for cash reconciliation or accounting purposes.
- This keeps day-to-day sales/best-seller data accurate, while still surfacing full cash-collected figures whenever needed.

7.3 Voiding Orders

- Void requires a personal manager/admin code (not shared) — protects accountability without creating a single point of failure.
- Reason required from a dropdown (wrong item, complaint, kitchen error, etc.), logged with requester and approver.

7.4 Receipts

- Digital or printed receipt generated per tab/sub-tab.

8. Inventory Management

- Station-scoped stock (Cafe / Bar / Food), each linked to menu-item recipes.
- Stock auto-deducts the moment an item is marked “Ready.”
- Low-stock alerts and auto-86 (auto-removal from the ordering menu) when an ingredient hits zero.
- Receiving log (supplier, cost, date) and a separate waste/spoilage log.

- Admin has full CRUD over stock items, recipes, and station tagging — since routing depends on this being accurate, it deserves careful setup review.

9. Staff Attendance — Tracking Only

- Clock in/out (PIN or QR) with break tracking and schedule adherence.
- Explicitly not connected to payroll or salary calculations — tracking and accountability only.
- Missed clock-out auto-flagged for Admin review.

10. Admin Dashboard

- Best Sellers — Top 3 shown by default, with a dropdown to expand (Top 5 / Top 10 / All), filterable by category and date range.
- Total Sales of the Day — live running total (food & drink sales, per Option C), with Corkage shown alongside as its own figure.
- Receipt History & Summary — searchable by date, table, staff, or amount; split tabs shown linked under their parent table.
- Menu Management (CRUD) — add/edit/delete items, prices, station tags, recipes, and availability.
- Team Chat oversight — Admin can view/moderate channels if needed.

11. Reporting & Spreadsheet Exports

- Report types: Sales (with/without corkage), Inventory, Attendance (tracking data only, not payroll).
- Time filters: Daily, Weekly, Monthly, and a fully custom date range, filterable further by station, staff, or category.
- One-click export to Excel (.xlsx) or CSV, or view the same data as an in-app dashboard/chart.
- Optional scheduled auto-export, e.g. a sales spreadsheet generated automatically every Monday morning.

12. Onboarding & Foolproofing

The architecture doesn't need to change to be safe for an untrained user — what matters is UI restraint: fewer decisions, obvious defaults, and confirmations before anything irreversible.

- Training Mode — a sandboxed copy of the interface for new hires to practice ordering, splitting, and voiding without touching real tickets, inventory, or chat.
- Confirmation step on every irreversible action: sending an order, processing payment, voiding an item.
- UI defaults always favor the simplest path — e.g. Split Evenly is the prominent button, Split by Item is secondary.

- Status shown with color + icon + text together, so it's never dependent on colour vision alone.

13. Future Suggestions (Not in Initial Build)

- Customer phone ordering — customers order (and optionally pay) from their own phone via a QR code at the table; feeds into the same station routing and tab/split logic as staff-placed orders.
- Reservation system tied to jazz set times.
- Sales-per-show reporting, useful for performer negotiations.
- Loyalty/membership tracking.
- Supplier auto-purchase-orders triggered by low stock.
- Deeper analytics: best-sellers by night/hour, slow-moving items.
- Kitchen printer fallback if a station tablet fails.
- Multi-location-ready data model, in case a second branch opens later.

14. Suggested Technical Approach (Local Network)

This runs entirely on the bar's local network (LAN) — no internet dependency for daily operation. One on-site device acts as the server; all tablets/terminals connect to it over Wi-Fi/Ethernet.

Layer	Recommendation	Notes
Front-end (tablets)	Responsive web app (React) or native tablet app	Affordable Android tablets; one app, role-based views
Back-end / API	Node.js or similar, REST + WebSocket	WebSockets power real-time order routing and Team Chat delivery
Database	PostgreSQL / MySQL	Stores orders, inventory, staff, chat — stored locally
Server	One always-on local machine (mini PC) on-site	No cloud subscription; local Wi-Fi/router provides the LAN
Hardware	1 waiter/cashier tablet + 1 per station (Cafe, Bar, Food) + optional printers	Can start with 4–5 tablets total, plus 1 server unit
Backups	Scheduled local backups (external drive / NAS)	No cloud copy by default — backups protect against device failure

15. Implementation Roadmap

Phase	Duration (est.)	Deliverables
1. Discovery & Menu Mapping	1–2 weeks	Roles, station tags, recipes, floor layout
2. Core POS + Flexible Tabs + Routing	4–5 weeks	Order entry, split-anytime tabs, station routing, statuses
3. Inventory Module	2–3 weeks	Stock, recipes, alerts, CRUD
4. Team Chats	1–2 weeks	Channels, DMs, quick-tags, pinned alerts
5. Attendance Module	1 week	Clock in/out tracking only
6. Admin Dashboard & Reports	2–3 weeks	Best sellers, sales totals, receipts, exports
7. Staff Training & Pilot	1–2 weeks	Training mode, live parallel test, feedback
8. Full Rollout	Ongoing	Go-live, monitoring

16. Next Steps

1. Confirm any remaining corkage details (bottle types covered, exceptions if any).
2. Provide the full menu with items categorized by station, plus recipes.
3. Confirm the exact single-floor table layout for the 2D view.
4. Decide Team Chat channel structure (per-station + all-staff, or more granular).
5. Approve Phase 1 (Discovery & Menu Mapping) to begin.

17. User Stories

Each story follows the format: As a [role], I want to [do something], so that [benefit]. Grouped by module so every part of the plan above is traceable to a concrete story a developer can build against.

17.1 Taking Orders & Table Layout

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-01	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to see a single 2D floor layout of all tables with color+icon status, so that I can tell at a glance which tables need attention.	Floor view loads by default; each table shows correct color, icon, and label matching its live state.
US-02	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to tap a table to open it as one tab by default, so that I don't have to decide upfront whether the group will split.	Tapping an empty table creates exactly one tab; no split prompt is forced at open.
US-03	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want a guided, confirm-before-send order flow, so that I don't accidentally send wrong items to a station.	Order cannot reach a station without a confirmation tap; items are editable before confirming.
US-04	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want a short undo window after sending an order, so that I can fix an honest mistake before the station starts prepping.	Undo is available for a configurable window (e.g. 15–30 sec) and removes the ticket from the station queue if used in time.

17.2 Order Routing

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-05	Cafe/Bar/Food Station	As a Station user, I want to see only tickets tagged to my station, so that my queue isn't cluttered with irrelevant orders.	Station screen never displays items tagged to a different station, except shared

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
			multi-station items.
US-06	Cafe/Bar/Food Station	As a Station user, I want a clear New → Preparing → Ready flow with one tap per stage, so that status updates are fast during service.	Each stage change is a single tap; current stage is visually obvious via color+icon+label.
US-07	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to see live per-station status for each order, so that I know when to deliver items together or stagger them.	Waiter's order view updates in real time as each station changes status, without manual refresh.
US-08	Admin	As an Admin, I want each menu item tagged to its correct station(s), so that orders always route correctly.	Every menu item has at least one station tag; multi-station items route to all tagged stations simultaneously.

17.3 Split Payments & Tabs

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-09	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to split a table's bill at any point — even after items were already sent or served — so that late split requests don't cause problems.	Split Tab is accessible from an open or served table at any stage before final payment; already-routed items are unaffected.
US-10	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want a one-tap ‘Split Evenly’ option, so that the common case of splitting a bill in half or thirds is fast.	Split Evenly divides the current total by an entered number of people in one action.

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-11	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to assign specific already-ordered items to separate tabs, so that groups who each want to pay only for what they ordered can do so.	Each item can be reassigned to a tab via tap/drag; totals recalculate immediately per tab.
US-12	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to merge tabs back together, so that I can correct a split if the group changes their mind.	Merge combines all items/totals from selected tabs back into one, with an audit entry of the change.
US-13	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to accept mixed tender within a split (e.g. cash + card), so that each person in a group can pay their own way.	Each sub-payment can use a different tender type; the tab only closes once its full total is covered.

17.4 Team Chats

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-14	All Staff	As any staff member, I want role/station-based chat channels, so that I can communicate with the right people without shouting across the bar.	Bar, Kitchen, Cafe, All-Staff, and Admin channels exist by default and are accessible per role permissions.
US-15	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want a quick-tag ‘Need Manager’ button on a table, so that I can call for help fast without typing.	Tapping the quick-tag sends a pre-filled, pinned message to the Admin/Manager channel with the table number attached.
US-16	Cafe/Bar/Food Station	As a Station user, I want to post urgent/pinned alerts (e.g. an item is 86'd), so that the whole floor sees it immediately.	Pinned messages appear at the top of relevant channels and

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
			trigger a distinct, noticeable notification.
US-17	Admin	As an Admin, I want to view and moderate all chat channels, so that I can maintain accountability and step in if needed.	Admin account can view full history of every channel and DM, and can remove inappropriate messages.

17.5 POS: Corkage, Voids, Receipts

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-18	System / Waiter	As a Waiter, I want the 20% corkage fee to apply automatically when a BYO bottle item is added, so that I never forget to charge it.	Selecting a BYO-bottle item auto-adds a 20% corkage line; no manual entry is possible or required.
US-19	Admin	As an Admin, I want corkage tracked separately from menu-item sales but viewable together, so that my sales reports stay accurate while cash reconciliation is still easy.	Total Sales of the Day excludes corkage by default; a separate Corkage total and a combined 'Total incl. Corkage' figure are both available.
US-20	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to request a void that requires a manager's personal code, so that voids are controlled and accountable.	Void is blocked until a valid personal manager code is entered; the log records requester, approver, item, and reason.
US-21	Waiter/Cashier	As a Waiter, I want to generate a receipt per tab, so that each group at	Each closed tab produces its own itemized receipt

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
		a split table gets their own correct receipt.	(digital or printed) tied only to that tab's items.

17.6 Inventory

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-22	Cafe/Bar/Food Station	As a Station user, I want stock to auto-deduct when I mark an item Ready, so that I don't have to manually update inventory during service.	Marking Ready deducts the exact recipe-linked quantities from that station's stock automatically.
US-23	Admin	As an Admin, I want low-stock alerts and auto-86 when an ingredient hits zero, so that we don't sell items we can't make.	Alert fires at a configurable threshold; item is automatically hidden from ordering when its key ingredient reaches zero.
US-24	Admin	As an Admin, I want full CRUD control over stock items and recipes, so that I can correct or update ingredient mappings as the menu changes.	Admin can create, edit, or remove stock items and recipe links without developer involvement.

17.7 Attendance

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-25	All Staff	As a staff member, I want to clock in/out with a PIN or QR, so that my attendance is accurately recorded without relying on a paper log.	Clock in/out requires personal PIN/QR; entry is timestamped and tied to that user only.
US-26	Admin	As an Admin, I want attendance data kept separate from payroll, so that it's	Attendance reports never

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
		used purely for tracking and accountability.	calculate or display pay amounts; explicitly labeled as tracking-only.
US-27	Admin	As an Admin, I want missed clock-outs auto-flagged, so that I can correct records without chasing staff manually.	Any session left open past a configurable time is flagged in a review queue for Admin correction.

17.8 Admin Dashboard & Reporting

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-28	Admin	As an Admin, I want to see the Top 3 best sellers by default with an option to expand, so that I get a quick read without digging through data.	Dashboard shows Top 3 on load; dropdown expands to Top 5/10/All, filterable by category and date.
US-29	Admin	As an Admin, I want to filter any report by Daily, Weekly, Monthly, or a custom date range, so that I can analyze exactly the period I need.	All report types accept the four filter modes, including a custom start/end date picker.
US-30	Admin	As an Admin, I want to export any report to Excel/CSV, so that I can share or archive data outside the system.	Export button produces a correctly formatted spreadsheet matching the current on-screen filter selection.
US-31	Admin	As an Admin, I want full CRUD access to menu items, so that I can update prices, availability, and station tags myself without developer help.	Admin can add, edit, archive, or delete menu items, with changes reflected immediately

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
			across POS and station routing.

17.9 Onboarding

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-32	Admin / New Hire	As an Admin, I want a Training Mode for new hires, so that they can practice on the real interface without risking live orders or data.	Training Mode is a fully separated sandbox; no action inside it writes to live tickets, inventory, or reports.

17.10 Future: Customer Phone Ordering

ID	Role	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-33	Customer (future)	As a customer, I want to order from my phone via a table QR code, so that I don't have to wait to flag down a waiter.	Scanning the table QR opens a menu scoped to that table; submitted orders route through the same station logic as staff-placed orders.